



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Operations

QUICK SERVE RESTAURANT MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of operations.
2. Describe strategies to minimize the cost of maintaining inventory.
3. Explain the relationship between customer service and distribution.
4. Identify the company's brand promise.
5. Take responsibility for decisions and actions.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the marketing manager for WRAP IT UP, a quick-serve restaurant that specializes in customizable wraps and salads. WRAP IT UP has been in business for five years, allowing customers to choose from a variety of fresh ingredients, sauces, and toppings to create their own wraps or salads. The restaurant is popular for its made-to-order approach, offering nearly unlimited customization options.

Recently, WRAP IT UP has experienced a noticeable increase in order preparation times, leading to longer wait times during peak hours and complaints from customers about slow service. The owner of WRAP IT UP (judge) is concerned that the long wait times are affecting customer satisfaction and repeat business.

The owner (judge) has asked you to evaluate potential solutions to streamline operations and speed up service without sacrificing the restaurant's unique selling point (USP) of offering highly customizable meals. One proposed solution is to reduce the number of customizable ingredients during peak hours, but this may affect customer satisfaction and the brand's identity.

You must weigh the pros and cons of limiting customization versus other operational changes, such as pre-preparing certain popular ingredients, optimizing the kitchen layout, or adjusting staff workflows. Consider how any changes might impact customer experience, brand perception, and overall sales.

You will present your recommendations to the owner (judge) in a role-play to take place in the owner's (judge's) office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How did you balance the trade-off between reducing customization and maintaining the restaurant's unique selling point (USP)?
2. How would you measure the success of your proposed solution in terms of both operational efficiency and customer satisfaction?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of operations?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Describe strategies to minimize the cost of maintaining inventory?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the relationship between customer service and distribution?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Identify the company's brand promise?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Take responsibility for decisions and actions?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						